DAY 15 | HANDS-ON ACTIVITIES

FDE Professional Skills 1: Simulation and Role Play Cards

Scenario cards for today's simulations and role plays. Facilitators: read the scenario aloud, set a timer, then debrief.

Prepared by **Ahmed** | linkedin.com/in/ahmed-al-imaad

How to work: read the whole card first. Agree roles. Stay in character until time is up. In the debrief, share one thing that worked and one thing to try next time.

Activity 1: Day One on Site

Format: Simulation, teams of 4, 40 minutes | **Skills:** ownership, curiosity, prioritisation

You arrive at a logistics company. The sponsor says: "Our delivery reports are always late and nobody trusts the numbers. Fix it." You have two hours before a check-in. As a team, decide who you will talk to, what you will look at, and what you will have to show at the check-in.

What good looks like

A short plan: 3 people to speak to (report owner, data engineer, a report user)
A list of 5 clarifying questions
One small deliverable for the check-in, such as a map of where the report data comes from with the slowest step marked
Assumptions written down

Tips

- Resist proposing a new platform in the first hour.
- Ask what "late" and "trust" mean to each person.
- Plan to show something concrete, even if small.

Activity 2: The Vague Request

Format: Role play, pairs, 3 rounds of 8 minutes | **Skills:** clarifying questions, active listening

Customer card: "We need an AI dashboard for our sales team. Can you have it by next week?" The customer knows the real issue is that sales managers cannot see which deals are at risk, but only reveals it if asked good questions. FDE: discover the real need and agree a first step.

What good looks like

Open questions: "What decision would this dashboard help you make?"
Summarising: "So the goal is spotting at-risk deals early, is that right?"
A first step that is small and testable: a one-page list of at-risk deals from existing data by Thursday

Tips

- Listen more than you talk.
- Summarise before you propose.
- Agree what "done" means for the first step.

Activity 3: The 30 Minute Prototype

Format: Timed sprint, teams of 3, 30 minutes | **Skills:** bias towards action, pragmatism

Use the support tickets data in today's notebook. The customer asks: "Why are our customers unhappy?" In 30 minutes, produce one chart, one table and three sentences of insight. Then present for 2 minutes.

What good looks like

Top 3 ticket categories by volume and by average resolution time
One clear chart with a title that states the finding
Assumptions stated: "We assumed priority labels are accurate"
A proposed next step

Tips

- Agree the question before touching the data.
- Good enough and shown beats perfect and hidden.
- State limitations openly.

Activity 4: Two-Way or One-Way Door?

Format: Group exercise, 15 minutes | **Skills:** decision making under uncertainty

Sort these into reversible or hard to reverse, and decide how fast to act on each: choosing a chart library for a demo; dropping an unused production table; promising a go-live date to the customer's CEO; renaming columns in your prototype; sharing raw customer data with a third-party tool; trying a new prompt in a test environment.

What good looks like

Reversible: chart library, renaming prototype columns, testing a prompt
Hard to reverse: dropping the table, promising a date, sharing data externally
For hard ones: who to consult and what to document

Tips

- If unsure, ask: "What does it cost to undo this?"

- Data and promises are usually one-way doors.

Activity 5: The Tough Update

Format: Role play, pairs, 2 rounds of 6 minutes | **Skills:** communication, ownership, escalation

The integration you promised for Friday is blocked because the customer's IT team has not granted database access. The customer's manager calls for an update and is already frustrated.

What good looks like

Situation: "The integration is built and tested on sample data, but blocked on database access."
Action: "I raised it with IT on Monday and Wednesday."
Next: "Once access is granted, I need one day to finish."
Ask: "Could you help get the access request approved today?"

Tips

- Lead with facts, not excuses.
- Own your part without blaming others.
- End with a specific, small ask.

Activity 6: Field Note to the Product Team

Format: Individual writing, 15 minutes | **Skills:** translation, feedback loops

From the day one simulation, write a short note to your product team about a gap you noticed that probably affects other customers too.

What good looks like

Title, customer context (anonymised), what happened, impact, how you worked around it, suggested product change
Under 200 words

Tips

- Separate what you observed from what you think.
- Anonymise customer details.

Genba (現場): the actual place where the work happens